

So, well, right-click on the Taskbar and go to 'Toolbars'. Here you will see various options including the Desktop bar and the Quick Launch bar. The Quick Launch bar is the row of icons that appear next to the Start button to help you launch programs with a single-click, instead of having to navigate through the Start Menu to look for them. This is a very handy toolbar and should be added immediately after a fresh install of Windows XP!

Next, right-click on the Taskbar and select 'Properties' to open the 'Taskbar and Start Menu Properties' dialog box. Under the 'Taskbar' tab, you'll see some basic options such as locking the taskbar to prevent inadvertent resizing or hiding. This is also the place where you can choose to auto-hide the Taskbar to get maximum real estate on your Desktop.

The next tab is the Start Menu tab, from where you can select whether to display the default applications for Internet and e-mail! You can also set the number of recently-used programs that are temporarily stored in the Start Menu! Clicking on 'Customise...' brings up the 'Customize Start Menu' dialog box, from where you can further edit all the settings. Everything is pretty easy to understand, and you should have no trouble changing these settings to your taste.

Icons

On first installing XP, you will notice that your Desktop contains nothing but the Recycle Bin icon. Most users will miss the standard My Documents, My Computer and My Network Places icons immediately. It's simple to get these back in place. Just right click on your Desktop and select 'Properties'. Now click on the 'Desktop'



The Taskbar tab



Customise the Start Menu